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Virginia Board of Education, Special Committee on Standards of Accreditation, Thursday, August 27, 2020

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_m_wh0bQEXE
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-26. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:00] - Awesome, thanks. - Perfect, thank you. How are you doing this morning? - Good, how are y'all? - Oh, great.

[00:00:29] - Good to all of you. - Good morning, I am Lee Hutchin. - Hello, good morning. - We are working on getting the live stream connected, so you might see our videos going in and out for a minute.

[00:00:46] - No problem, thank you for having us. - Yeah, looks like we may be, Kevin, are we live? - We went live and I switched back over. - Okay, thank you. problem um ben and elissa do you all want when we get to your presentation do you all um want to share your screen so that you can control the presentation or would you like me to share my screen and i obviously would have your presentation pulled up i'm comfortable with whatever works

[00:01:21] best for you all um i think we can go ahead and i'll go ahead and share my screen we've been

[00:01:27] practicing running through it so great yep no problem we'll do thank you then you should have

[00:02:08] rights to do it now because i'm changing it to all panelists um so you you should be good to go and our um when we get to you all's presentation our chair is going to introduce the ucs team and then turn it over to you guys and that's when i'll pull down the one i'm sharing and pull up uh you you can pull

up your presentation that works thank you emily this is alissa when it comes to q a is that something that you all are planning to run for us or what is that going to look like

[00:02:47] oh um when we get to q a it's really just a discussion um because we'll um turn it back over to board members to see you know what what questions they have um if you guys if it's not a question that you all feel like you can answer feel free to pass it back over to us um but our q a we really just handle more as a kind of a group discussion okay great so i won't need to really call on anyone or anything it'll just sort of you think it'll just no um our chair will be

[00:03:24] the one to kind of call on folks um you know if they have questions perfect thank you good morning

[00:07:14] everybody just to let you know um we're just waiting on everyone to join but the live stream is going we'll get started here um in a couple of minutes once we have all of our board members in

[00:07:27] our chair good morning dr duran good morning how are you today i'm well how are you very good

[00:09:57] thank you good morning pam how are you good morning guys it's good to see you am like good to see everybody else yeah just to let you guys know we uh do have the live stream going um so we still have a couple of minutes until 10 o'clock and we'll wait for folks to hop on and then we'll get started hey sounds good i'm gonna turn my camera off into that okay good morning jamel morning emily pam francisco hi ben and anybody else who's on the call that i can't see right now

[00:10:34] good morning jamel it's good to see all of you pam are you all started back to school yet we started on the 20th okay four days a week with the fifth on as remote gotcha everything going as can be expected and right now i know it's a challenge you know in this environment every day is getting better and uh every issue that we run into we're able to overcome

[00:11:11] it and adapt so it's it's going pretty well good that's great I know your kiddos I know you're excited to have them back oh gosh yes yes I know we have more folks joining us just for those that have hopped on we are live streaming we've got a couple minutes till 10 o'clock so we're just

[00:11:47] waiting on the last of our folks to hop on and then we'll get started in a couple of minutes

[00:11:52] Good morning. Good morning, Sonia. Good morning. Morning, everyone. Morning. Just to let folks know, we're waiting on the last couple of people to hop on. We are live streamed on YouTube, and we'll get started here in just a minute.

[00:13:23] All right. I do have that it's 10 o'clock and we have all of our board members and all of our presenters here. I know we may have a couple more folks hopping on here in the next couple minutes, but Dr. Pexton, I will go ahead and if you're ready, turn it over to you.

[00:14:44] Yes, thank you. Good morning, Emily and everyone else. Thank you for joining us today for our meeting of the special committee to review the standards of accreditation. While today's meeting is off cycle from our traditional board meeting, the committee felt it was important to press forward and our review of the standards of accreditation and school accountability.

[00:15:07] I do want to take a moment just to say I'm excited to and have been looking forward to this meeting. You know, this forum, unfortunately, is becoming more and more comfortable having these types of meetings virtually. You know, as I was preparing for this meeting, one thing that I realized that I

was missing from our traditional board setting is the ability prior to some of the committee meetings to lean over to Pam or to lean over to previously Kim and, you know, ask some questions and catch up and center up on some thoughts just to just prepare and also catch up with each other and see how everybody was doing so it's always good just to see familiar faces

[00:15:47] and to get back together again and just talk about some important things and work together on some important things so looking forward to today's meeting uh today's meeting will feature two comprehensive presentations uh the first presentation will be from bdoe staff on the 2017 soa revisions a review of state accreditation data trends and an update on school quality actions and technical assistance for the second presentation we are joined by staff from the education commission of the state where they will provide an overview of state accountability systems

[00:16:24] across the country following each presentation there will be time for discussion and q a from committee members but before we dive into the presentations um i'll ask if the committee members have had a chance to review the minutes from the July 22nd 2020 committee meeting I'll take some virtual nods if that's okay all right great so can I get a motion to approve or amend the minutes for the July 22nd 2020 committee meeting I move to approve the minutes thank you Dr. Duran I had a

[00:17:01] second from Jamel thank you Dr. Wilson all in favor do I do do I need to do a roll call Emily yes because we're virtual we do need to do a roll call okay all right so i'll have to do this by looking at the videos um so i may go out of our traditional order i'll start with dr duran

[00:17:26] all right pamela davis vought hi dr wilson aye uh mr gecker president gecker does he doesn't officially i don't get to vote yeah but i would go to i if i could vote awesome thank you none opposed so the motion passes all right we will move on uh for our first presentation um before

[00:18:02] we do i will say i trust that the committee has taken the time to at least review the presentations and the information provided by the video video vdoe in preparation for today's committee meeting i'm looking forward to as much as i'm sure you are learning much more about this information but before we do I do want to recall some interest that was expressed at our last board meeting by several of our board committee meeting by several of our committee members I recall both Dr. Duran Dr. Wilson and myself all expressed a shared and very accurate opinion that many of us agreed that

[00:18:38] this committee's first priority should be examining the positive negative and unintended outcomes of the current accreditation indicators and I'm very encouraged that the information that I've previewed today will begin to take us down that path of understanding but I do know I do from my assessment see that there's some opportunities for us to continue that discussion um and to gather some additional information um and talking with Emily Webb towards the end of this meeting we'll talk about what those opportunities look like but I just point that out because I know that that was something that was uh very poignantly pointed out at the last

[00:19:14] meeting and so while I think we do begin that discussion very well today I do see opportunities to continue that discussion in future committee meetings also if you recall at our last meeting dr lane encouraged the committee members to review the three subsections of the soa regarding its purpose uh philosophy goals and objectives and student achievement expectations prior to today's meeting i believe we will learn more about this information and during our first presentation and we'll have an opportunity to ask some clarifying questions that the committee may have so with that

[00:19:49] for our first presentation today we are joined by holly coy assistant superintendent for policy equity and communication dr leslie sale excuse me director of policy dr jennifer piveretta director of research dr leah ortiz director of school quality and dr linda revia school quality consultant again if possible uh where possible we ask committee members to hold their questions until the end of the presentation. So now I will turn it over to Holly and Leslie to

[00:20:24] get us started. Wonderful. Thank you, Dr. Pexton. Good morning, President Gecker, Dr. Lane, and members of the board. My name is Holly Coy, and I serve as the Assistant Superintendent for Policy, Equity, and Communications at the Department. It's my pleasure this morning to kick off the presentations with Dr. Sayle and provide an overview of the standards of accreditation.

[00:20:52] Emily is bringing up some slides to guide this, but I'm really just going to introduce what we're going to do this morning from a staff perspective. So Dr. Sayle and I will provide some information about the foundations and the kind of deriving purpose of the standards of accreditation, and then walk through its eight parts with you. From there, Dr. Pivorena will provide an overview of the data that reflects impacts of the 2017 changes, which Dr. Sale and I will also be walking

[00:21:27] you through kind of part by part. After that, Dr. Ortiz and Dr. Arribio will present on the impacts this has had on school quality efforts and the technical assistance that their office provides to the field. So we're going to start with the beginning, so to speak. The standards of accreditation are really the driving underpinnings of ensuring the provision of a high quality public education within an accountability system to all elementary, middle, and high schools.

[00:22:03] They are required by the Code of Virginia and the code lists a number of things that the standards must include but it's interesting that the code also notes that these should outline the philosophy goals and objectives of public education in Virginia and so even the code recognizes that the importance and the role that the standards of accreditation play uh in in being a driving force uh and a guiding star for what public education should be in the commonwealth so as

[00:22:36] I mentioned the standards have eight parts our conversation around accreditation and what you've heard in this committee previously about school quality indicators and measures are really focused in on that part eight the accreditation pieces so today we're going to focus on parts one through seven and walk you through what else is in there outside of those accreditation pieces in part eight and we're going to emphasize the decisions that were made during the 2017 revision process so that you get a feel for what has changed in the last few years and then we'll transition

[00:23:15] over to Dr. Pai Varenna to talk about the data and what that says about the potential impacts that this new quote unquote version of the SOA has had in Virginia. So with that I'm going to turn it over to Dr. Sale to walk through parts one through seven with you. And Emily if you'll take oh perfect um so good morning everyone um and thank you for for having me it's it's good to see everyone um albeit in a virtual setting um and thanks holly for that introduction um as holly

[00:23:49] mentioned um what we've done in the past is is kind of focus on that that accreditation measure and and part eight um but there are a lot of policy kind of oriented components that proceed that part eight portion that we've already been discussing a little bit more in depth So I'm going to walk you through that part this morning, but just to provide a little bit of context, the material that I'm going to cover over the course of this relatively short presentation is actually incorporated into 26 sections in the

standards of accreditation. So we're covering a lot of content and detailed content in a short amount of time. So for the sake of that and to

[00:24:28] go on this whirlwind tour, we are going to keep it organized into the parts that we've been discussing and kind of how we've been framing and organizing the standards of accreditation in our minds already um so again we'll be moving through a number of different sections but but keeping them organized thematically into their parts um so we'll move into part one oh so this is actually um the core revision side of things um and i apologize i forgot this was coming prior to and this is actually sets the stage for what we're going to talk talk through in the parts i won't go into too much detail here because i think you'll notice that these items are already

[00:25:07] going to be threaded through and discussed in depth as we get into the meat of the individual parts but again the core revisions that we're going to see that kind of tie everything together as we emphasize what happened in the revision in 2017 really recognize the multiple areas that affect school quality and the need for continuous improvement and you'll see a lot of components that tie us back into that profile of a Virginia graduate including the the revision of our graduation requirements and verified credits our increasing career exposure exploration and planning

[00:25:43] including expanded opportunities for work-based learning experiences and internships and then of course we're going to see the five c's come up pretty regularly which is critical thinking creative thinking collaboration communication and citizenship which i know you guys could could recite in your sleep so part one um our definitions and purpose um the name does it justice it does just that so it provides us with the definitions that are going to give us the concepts and terms that are critical to us as we move throughout the document um i don't have specifics in terms of

[00:26:19] what we change and of course i could could talk about this um if there are any questions with regard to what definitions have changed um but really the the thing of note here is that we just wanted to make sure that the concepts and how we use these terms and ideas throughout the document were truly reflected in the definitions section. So from a kind of user-friendliness standpoint, it really sets the stage for how we talk about some important concepts on an ongoing basis throughout the document. The purpose, which was expanded pretty considerably in the revision in

[00:26:54] 2017 sets our intent statement so it enumerates five things that the standards of accreditation intend to do over the course of the document what we have in front of us on these five items are pulled directly from the standards of accreditation as part of the revision the board was very intentional in their their language and what they wanted to present here so i certainly didn't want to take any liberties and what we put forth as what we we intend this document to do but i will quickly walk through those those five items for us and these are our action verbs so the standards of accreditation are meant to provide us an essential foundation for educational programs of

[00:27:33] high quality in all schools and for all students they encourage and promote school quality and acknowledge achievement on a continuous basis and of course recognizing improvements that are made by our schools and divisions we foster public confidence that our graduating students are leaving the Virginia public school system with the masteries and competencies that we would like them to have. We assure that Virginia's public schools are recognized by our other institutions of learning and we establish a means of determining the effectiveness of schools as

[00:28:09] provided by the standards of quality with a particular emphasis on student learning and and student outcomes in those multiple areas that affect student quality. So part two, our philosophy, goals, and objectives.

[00:28:27] Whereas I kind of imagine the, and not imagine, but as I organize my own thoughts around the standards of accreditation, part one being where we establish the intent of the document, part two is where we establish the intent of our authors, being the board in this case.

[00:28:44] So I will highlight a few of the big revisions come from the the process that was finalized in 2017 and it really emphasizes this kind of concept of well-roundedness for our graduates and our virginia public school students both in terms of mastery as it applies to academics workplace personal interests um knowledges civic and community responsibility but as well as skill sets um so they really want those students to be you know well-rounded when they leave the virginia public school system and when we talk about well-roundedness with respect to skills again we tie back into those

[00:29:18] five c's that we see pretty regularly throughout the document um again another kind of thematic item that we see over the course of the document that we reiterate in our philosophy as kind of a driving principle behind the standards of accreditation is our system of accountability that highlights continuous improvement so while while we have very high performing schools and school divisions there's always room for growth and improvement to better serve our students so always looking forward in our in our system of public education here and then of course the promotion and recognition of school quality that as schools make those you know targeted improvements

[00:29:57] and take those steps forward that they're getting recognized for those advancements so part three where and and i guess i should preface this too so whereas part one and part two i think really set the context of the document of part three i see this as kind of a transition where we start to look more in detail like kind of the operations those items that are going to affect the day-to-day and operational components of our schools as they relate to the standards of accreditation so this first part part three on student achievement expectation and requirements for graduation again the name capture is exactly what's included in this section it sets our

[00:30:36] expectations for grade promotion assessments how assessments translate to remediation and then the requirements for the assimilation of transfer students as kind of per the a lot of the core components that we were discussing in the 2017 revision process one of the the larger revisions that came from the process really center and kind of focus on the role of assessments and so you'll see here the the bulleted items that list the notable revisions focus on when assessments are are taken and how they're used and i will note i i'll give

[00:31:12] you guys a moment to kind of digest this but as you guys do i think probably one of the most significant revisions to come from the 2017 process and worth highlighting for you guys is that last bullet that students shall not be required to take an end of course sol test and of course after they have already earned the verified credits required for that academic content area for graduation so this is one of the bullet items that kind of encapsulates our take on assessments that we want them as a tool for for evaluating student achievement but not to overemphasize the role of assessments as particularly as we get our students to the finish

[00:31:50] line our graduation requirements which is also part part of part three but this is a lot of content here and there were quite a number of changes that came from our graduation requirements

section so this merited its own slide here you'll see on the graphics that i have on the right hand side these are focusing on our class that was incoming as of 2018 and 2019 so our tentatively our class of 2022. so of course we still have graduate students that are under the old graduation

[00:32:25] requirements but this particular slide emphasizes what's changed from those former graduation requirements to the new cohort that began in 2018-2019. So for this group of students, and again to align with the kind of reimagining our role of assessments here, we changed the number of required verified credits for graduation. The number of standard units of credit remained the same for both standard and advanced diplomas, but you'll see here for our standard diploma the number of verified credits was reduced from six to five eliminating the student selected

[00:33:02] test and with our advanced diploma it went from nine to five with the elimination of the student selected test and the reduction of verified credits in math science and history and social science so for our advanced diploma it was a considerable reduction in our number of verified credits there i will just note that the again the number of standard units of credit required did did remain the same between the two graduation cohorts. So in addition to reducing the number of verified credits, we also revised the pathways to getting verified credits. So we expanded the options for locally awarded verified credits to English and mathematics, and we also set a limit

[00:33:41] on the number of locally aware awarded verified credits that can be used towards graduation to be no more than one. But a major difference between the old graduation requirements and the new ones, both in the number of LAVCs that are allowed to be applied to graduation but that these can be applied to both standard and advanced diplomas so whereas that wasn't the case in prior cohorts that is the case now and then the verified credit can be earned when an authentic of performance assessment in writing and history and we know there's been a little bit back and forth about whether we could actually implement the performance assessment for history and social

[00:34:19] science based on some additional language in the appropriation act but as of this past appropriation act we are kind of moving forward on that process so that had formerly been prohibited but now will be an option for our graduating students part four is our school instructional programs and this is where we get into a lot of the details of how we implement the profile of the virginia graduate so it touches on elementary middle and high school and gets into items like core instruction requirements, what other required instruction there is, and a number

[00:34:58] of different components that are the kind of building blocks of our instructional programs in schools. The big revisions here, again, I noted the profile of the Virginia graduate being kind of the guiding principle for how we structured the instructional programs in these sections. But one of the big changes was our shift in emphasis from kind of exclusively around preparing our students for college, to preparing our students for generally for life, whether that be college or career readiness. And so you'll see additional opportunities for both career exposure and career exploration in our school instructional programs and the revision

[00:35:37] that became finalized in 2017. And it happens at earlier years as well. And one notable item in the school instructional program section as well is this is where we also build out our standard and verified credits so as they apply to graduation we noted that in the the previous part but this part really builds out what a standard unit of credit looks like what a verified unit credit looks like and the pathways

and so with the new revision we added some additional pathways to verified credits including those opportunities for locally awarded verified credits and authentic

[00:36:11] performance assessments so of course we have folks at the helm of our schools and we need to make sure they're they're well prepared and and qualified and of course have the supports that they need to to promote school quality school health and school improvement so this is the part of the standards of accreditation that dive into the roles and expectations of our leaders and instructional staff and set parameters around staffing requirements and teaching loads some of our big revisions in 2017 included making sure that our expectations and roles aligned with

[00:36:48] advancing virginia's leadership agenda so making sure that there were avenues to have strong leaders in each of our schools and our divisions we made sure that our language around school counselors at all grade levels aligned with what was in the code of virginia um a huge element of clarity for how we operationalize these in these school divisions were around teaching loads and planning periods um so we made that a little bit more accessible to division leaders who are figuring out how to incorporate planning time and staffing loads um and and did it very much more matter-of-factly i guess and and what the expectations were for the number of students on a roster and the amount of

[00:37:27] time that a teacher should expect to get in for a planning period or planning time and lastly um so parts six and parts seven these are relatively short parts as as if you relate them to the rest of the the sections we've covered here today so part six being the school facilities and school safety sections there weren't a ton of changes to this particular part in the 2017 revisions it was really just us comporting with some changes that happened through the general assembly process

[00:38:04] and that are codified in the code of virginia and then part seven being our school communications section um and the big edit here was that we we tied in that language about the school quality profiles as opposed to the performance report cards so with that being said i will hand it back to holly to guide us to the the next stage of the conversation um and of course as as we get to the near the end of the um presentation happy to take any questions about details of what's included

[00:38:37] great thank you leslie um so as you'll see here we're going to transition over to the outcomes of these 2017 changes to the standards um the the data is primarily driven by accreditation but um dr piverena is going to share some information with you about the the trends um and from there then we will segue over to the Office of School Quality with Dr. Ortiz and Dr. Arivia about the implications to them. So with that, I will hand it over to Dr. Pai Verona to walk us through the data.

[00:39:10] Great. Well, thank you so much and good morning. I am going to focus my presentation on several specific data elements that reflect the possible impacts of the intentional changes to the SOA in 2017 the same sort of theme that Holly and Leslie just covered. There are generally as you know two years of data available so when you were looking at the graphs here keep in mind that data that was collected in 2017 and 18 is used to determine the 2018-19 accreditation ratings and data that

[00:39:48] are collected in 2018-19 are used to determine the 19-20 accreditation ratings. There are Five topics that I'm going to cover, one that didn't make the bullet here, but it is in the slides, that really focus on the significant changes to the SOA that we can visualize in the data at this point. One of the big changes obviously is moving from a pass rate to a combined rate to describe performance academic achievement in schools. We also added chronic absenteeism as a new indicator and so although we use we measure that through the all students group so all students

[00:40:27] in a school we are going to look as well by student group because i think there's some important context there and we're going to look at the graduation and completion index so the changes that leslie discussed related to graduation have not quite phased in yet in terms of the cohort that's impacted but there were some uh immediate changes in terms of particularly credit accommodations for students with disabilities that i think that we might be able to see some trends in the data so we're going to talk a little bit about that dropout rate was a new indicator so we will look at that as well and then the last piece that we're going to look at is the improvements

[00:41:07] that schools have made in their performance levels between the first and the second year of implementation so a sense of how schools are improving in their rates for these indicators over time one of the things that's not included today for the sake of of time and brevity is a closer examination of the academic achievement among student groups we have some brief information to share on that but that i think requires a pretty in-depth discussion to understand some of the context around how we measure academic achievement in student groups and some of the

[00:41:42] trends we're seeing there's lots to unpack there so i will allude to it throughout the presentation but likely we'll need to cover it in depth at a different time. Next slide. So you've seen this slide before. I just wanted to include it here as a reminder of the components of the combined rate because we are going to look at the combined rates in detail. So in the previous accreditation system we measured student achievement based on a pass rate. The combined rate builds upon that by also factoring in student growth. And for English, the English combined rate also factoring in English

[00:42:21] learner progress. One of the big values of the combined rate is that while it does show schools that are doing well across all three of those components, it also becomes a little bit easier to identify schools where students are not passing and also not demonstrating growth or progress.

[00:42:39] So these are the schools where, you know, we tend to think the role of the Office of School Quality comes in where they're working with schools that have lower performance on the combined rate they're not showing students are not passing and they're not showing growth or progress and i'm going to show this visually in in just a second so i wanted to make the distinction there next slide so again just getting you oriented to combined rates this is an example from a school in the commonwealth we just changed the name of it this is a 2018-19 pass rate for this school

[00:43:15] compared to their combined rate so you can see in english their pass rate was 68 68 of the students passed the assessments in english when we calculate the combined rate for the school it moves to 73 that includes 73 that includes an additional 93 students who failed the sol but showed growth or english learner progress and so they're included in the calculations here math is similar so a 64% pass rate, but a 68% combined rate, it reflects an additional 51 students at this particular school who failed the SOL but showed growth. I just wanted to provide an example

[00:43:55] for context as we move into looking at school level pass rates. And my last tutorial slide here, it may have been a while since you took middle school math, so I thought it would just be important to include in here a really brief overview of a box plot and its parts and i'm going to talk through these when we present them on the next slide but i wanted to kind of give you a rationale of why we chose to display box plots it's not necessarily a traditional measure that we typically use in these types of presentations but as you know state accreditation

[00:44:32] is a school level system it's a school level measure it's a school level rating and so we don't calculate division or state level combined rates they would be difficult to interpret anyway at that level because there are different parts and components to the rate so what we care about when we're thinking about state accreditation is how individual schools are improving or not based on where they they were and so the box plot allows you to see the distribution of the data for each individual school um as a whole without um and kind of gives you some some descriptive

[00:45:08] statistics the median um the upper and lower quartiles to understand the variability in that data across a given year so just to orient you to this the median is that the 50th percentile it's not an average or a mean which is what we typically talk about when we think about rates so just note that distinction um the upper uh quartile and the lower quartile the box itself represents the range from the 75th to the 20th percentile of the data. The whiskers on the plot,

[00:45:42] which are the arms that extend out, represent sort of the statistical bulk of the data, if you will. So if you're thinking about it in terms of a normal curve, this is going to be the ends of the tails in your distribution. And then the box plots also indicate where there are outliers. So So those are data points that are beyond the statistical extremes for a given distribution of data.

[00:46:11] So one of the questions that we asked ourselves when thinking about the impact of the standards of accreditation is how has the distribution of English performance changed with a combined rate? And so what you see here on the slide are box plots like we just discussed.

[00:46:27] The bluish, tealish color, depending on your screen resolution, is the pass rate. And so the 14, 15, 15, 16, and 16, 17 is when we were calculating pass rates for accreditation. And so those are reflected there.

[00:46:43] The 82, 83, and 84 is the median. Again, just a reminder, it's not an average. It is the median of the distribution of that data. And so what you see for, as you move into our first and second year of implementation of the new accreditation system, Not surprisingly, you see a bit of a dip in the median pass rate.

[00:47:08] That's consistent with what we're seeing across the state in terms of English performance. But a couple of things to note here. So not surprising as well, the combined rate, the medians there are gonna be higher, right? We're adding in some additional elements in terms of student growth and progress.

[00:47:24] I think it's important to note that they're not extremely or exceedingly higher, right? There was a concern, I think, when we were developing this, the combined rate was going to make our performance look astronomical because we were adding in student growth and progress but it does give schools a little bit of a boost and statewide a couple of points of a boost in terms of what we're looking at here but it's not extreme by any means in terms of the difference between the two i think the biggest takeaway that i want you to see in this slide is the distribution of the data of each school's data within the combined

[00:48:02] rate so if you're looking at the whiskers or the antennas whatever you want to call them on the box plots you will see that for the 2017-18 pass rate the top upper extreme and the lower extreme are pretty far apart right they almost cover the entire distribution of the data when we move into the combined rate where you can see that those whiskers are closer together which tells me visually that the data is much more much less variable much more condensed into those upper values and that's really important when you're trying to identify low performing schools which

[00:48:40] is part of the purpose for accreditation is to identify those schools that need state assistance and support it's much easier for us to figure out where to spend our time and resources when we're thinking about who the outliers are versus who's at the end of the tail there are fewer schools that are at the end of the tail than there are those outliers there so what we're seeing are the value of the combined rate in this case is that those truly low performing schools those schools where there's low pass rates where there's very little growth or progress are coming out as outliers at the bottom of our distribution and therefore are easier to identify in terms of

[00:49:19] support so the same pattern is true of math although in 2018-19 you do see a little bit of a bump here because of the change in assessment and the change in cut score but again the combined rate is slightly higher the median combined rate is slightly higher than the the median pass rate but you also do see that change in distribution it's not as stark here as it is in english but you can see that the whiskers on the box plot are a little bit closer together when looking at

[00:49:56] the combined rate indicating that schools are starting to sort of condense towards that top part and those outliers at the bottom are where we really need to be thinking about interventions and those are going to be your schools that are identified as level two or level three performers in this indicator of academic achievement right so i mentioned that chronic absenteeism is a new indicator for us in the accreditation system uh just as a reminder that the definition of chronic absenteeism is defined as missing 10 or more of the school year and that is a student level or

[00:50:35] individually student level calculated measure meaning that we base it on an individual student's number of days in membership and so what you see here is a really interesting trend in that the rate of chronic absenteeism was increasing from 2014 to 2016-17. For the all students group, that's the black line on your slide here, it was 12% in 2016-17, reduced to 10.7% by 18-19, so a little over a percentage point decline. And so for chronic absenteeism, remember it's sort of

[00:51:15] reverse so up is good up is bad down is good lower rates are good here and so you see for most student groups we are seeing declines across the board in chronic absenteeism that is a good thing i think there are as you can see on the slide some concerning trends particularly in this last year in 1819 that is for english learners and likely hispanics those are likely students that are identified in both groups and so that is i think a trend that we're seeing in several outcomes that we'll talk about in the next couple of slides where english learners

[00:51:51] in particular seem to have a different pattern than the rest of the state but overall the chronic absenteeism rates in across student groups and across schools are dropping next slide so graduation and completion index as i mentioned when i introduced this at the beginning the The changes that we made in terms of the cohort haven't completely phased in yet, but we did have some changes that took place immediately in terms of credit accommodations and some flexibility there for students with disabilities.

[00:52:24] It's a little difficult to see in this graph because they're all sort of bunched at the top there, but you can see that in general the rates for the graduation and completion index are holding steady, maybe slightly increasing, but the purple line on the graph, which is students with disabilities. You can see it was declining through 2016-17 and is back on the increase in 17-18 and 18-19. Just a theory that perhaps the credit accommodations there are really assisting students with getting that standard diploma when they're ready to graduate. And again,

[00:53:01] you know, we see some really concerning trends here in terms of English learners and Hispanic students uh hispanic students being the green line english learners being the blue line where their rates have consistently been below average if you will for the state but also are continuing to decline next slide so dropout rate is a new indicator for the accreditation system as well and you can see here it's almost the inverse of the graduation and completion index so lower

[00:53:34] rates here are better. Generally holding steady, but you are also seeing similar to the other slide an increase from 14-15 to 16-17 among students with disabilities and dropout rates, and then it has declined since then. Again, just a theory that that might be due to some of the flexibilities that are offered through the SOA to help those students graduate.

[00:54:00] and again as well you see the green line for hispanic students the blue line for english learners their rates are consistently higher than other groups in the state but they are also on the increase next slide so the final question that i wanted to answer is what do we see when we think about schools that are improving over time so this is just a brief reminder of the performance levels that we have for our accreditation system because we're going to look at some trends in the next slide um and i i think what's important here is when you're looking at the overall trend lines

[00:54:39] like we just looked at it's really um you know you can't see sort of individual school improvement you're talking about state level rates so when we think about improvements in performance levels so schools that have gone from level three to level two or level two to level one and are making strides to improve their rates that's kind of where some of the meat is in terms of the accreditation system so that was the last question we wanted to ask on this presentation which is the next slide and so this one's a bit heavy so i'll go over it with you we'll take the first line so

[00:55:15] for the academic achievement indicator in english for all students in 2018-19 which is the first year that we released these new accreditation ratings there were 112 schools that were level two or level three in 2019 and 20 which is the second year that we released the accreditation rating 23 of those 112 had an improved performance level so they either went from level three to level two or level two to level one so that represents about 20 21 of those schools that

[00:55:49] had an improvement in their performance level and as you go down the last column there you can see that the performance levels were greatly improved in math that is in part contributing to the change in assessment and the cut scores, but even indicators like science which haven't changed in assessment, chronic absenteeism as a new indicator, the graduation and completion index which was relatively flat in terms of its statewide trends, you're seeing quite a few schools that are showing improvement. So we think this presents a more granular look at how schools

[00:56:25] are improving uh over time and making strides than just looking at the state rates um you know we only had 27 schools for example in 2018 or 19 that were level two or level three uh in the graduation and completion index now that's out of about 300 or so high schools right it's not all schools that have that indicator but 27 out of about 300 or so that were level two or level three but 18 of those 27 improve their performance level so you know it's a small number that are impacted here but they are making some strides for improvement which is what we want to see and so that is where i will

[00:57:02] conclude my presentation all right and then that begins our part so greetings um to president gecker and the board it's a pleasure to meet you all um i'm just joining the team well i'm a month in and

thank you dr revia for joining me as well um since i know you've been a part of this the transition in the office and so with the revisions to the standards of accreditation

[00:57:35] it gave our office an opportunity to reflect on processes and make revisions from a compliance driven model to a model of coaching and so first in order to personalize support our office transitioned to a regional model and this allowed the office of school quality to truly assess the needs of the division and build relationships with those division and school leaders and so prior to my arrival and something we continue to refine are the tools for monitoring and shifting to a more collaborative approach in this area and so we're going to get thank you and so in addition to

[00:58:14] providing technical assistance under the framework of continuous improvement our office is collaborating within the agency and with partners to also continue our professional learning as we focus on building the capacity of division and school leaders and so our office has laid the ground work and communication for professional learning networks for divisions with similar needs or opportunity gaps we are are proud to have collaborated and produced monthly communication that highlights key components of school improvement and resources because we understand

[00:58:53] that effective and consistent communication is essential to the field dr revia is there anything you'd like to add okay so we'll go to the next i think dr revia wants to add but she's on mute i you're talking oh i'm sorry emily if you'll go back a slide please um i wanted to provide the

[00:59:31] board with some specific examples so for developing professional learning communities we have found um as uh was just shared with you that there is um some challenges across virginia and children uh in achieving on literacy so we provided a series under the teacher leader support of uh sessions for our school divisions who already currently had MOUs or were in the process of getting them, which would have included Danville and Prince Edward.

[01:00:03] And we had a series of Saturday sessions for teachers to review the current standards of learning as well as receive instruction on effective pedagogical strategies to improve student engagement.

[01:00:19] And these sessions were led by master teachers in the field. So when we talk about developing professional learning communities, we were having teachers working with teachers in appropriate grade bands. So we didn't have high school teachers working with kindergarten teachers.

[01:00:36] We were really looking at how to improve the efficacy of instruction. And so from those sessions, they went back and deployed and implemented the strategies they learned, came back and shared them out, and then were encouraged to post their lesson plans and resources in the GoOpenVirginia portal that I know that you have heard about.

[01:00:59] So again, we are trying to promote that there's not one single solution and that each school and school community has some unique characteristics, but if we can improve and be impactful in helping teachers engage learners with effective strategies, then we're going to enhance student success.

[01:01:19] Our principal leader support this year was impacted by the pandemic, as you may have figured it might've happened. We had our principal leader program already set to deploy and then the pandemic hit. And so we are ready to deploy that in 2021 once school divisions open up and get underway, then we will transition that from a face-to-face support to a virtual learning support and embedded within that will be professional learning networking opportunities.

[01:01:52] So I think that hopefully just gives you a couple of examples of how OSQ is shifting from specific teacher classrooms to working holistically within a school. So Emily, if you'll go to the next slide.

[01:02:08] So we are doing this in conjunction with the superintendent's region. So the staff within OSQ have been assigned regions and then are working within that region to identify patterns and trends to see how we might effectively use our resources and also connect school divisions with one another.

[01:02:27] We also understand that oftentimes our most challenged schools and school divisions are asked to do additional work above and beyond. So in the Office of School Quality, we spent this winter actually revising our monitoring tools for federal and state accreditation and combining them into one.

[01:02:47] We piloted it in four school divisions working with staff in those school divisions, and we're ready to deploy that and then COVID hit. So you might imagine that schools were a little challenged to be able to have us come on site when schools were closed.

[01:03:09] So we are positioned to deploy this virtually in the coming school year. What has changed in this technical support model is that instead of coming in with a checklist and looking to see, have you done X, Y, Z? We are working with the division level and building-based staff, asking them to provide us with artifacts in advance.

[01:03:32] Then we went into the school divisions with those leaders and had face-to-face conversations. And then we made classroom visits only at the request of the division. And that varied by one division to another. So what we know is that people are much more receptive to improvement if you can engage them from the beginning and capitalize on and leverage the resources they already have.

[01:03:59] I know as a board, while you expect all school divisions to be successful in their instructional work with students, you also acknowledge that a small school division that's rural or urban operates in some different ways perhaps a large school division that's a suburban school division so osq is trying to make sure that we identify the unique strengths and unique challenges and then partner with the school division as to how we can deploy resources understanding that one size does not fit all

[01:04:33] so we were really pleased to have that support model piloted it really the school divisions we're pleased to not have to do multiple uh meetings we were able to triangulate data and uh we will see that uh going forward as as uh our mode of operation and know that that will have a positive impact next slide emily and so dr rubia did a good job of capturing that that our outcomes and data are limited um just because of the rollout of certain uh programs and so we

[01:05:10] also realized she summed it up that a one size model doesn't fit all and so from the office of school quality um we want to make sure that our processes are working with schools to meet their needs while keeping the focus on improved student outcomes thank you okay and so while the uh the data as jen mentioned before is limited we are using that data and helping our school divisions better understand their data so that they can move forward and i think that this last item where it

[01:05:44] says the time of the revisions of the soa and then combined with the pandemic has really allowed the office of school quality to have additional conversations with school divisions to say you can use standardized testing as one point that is collected statewide but what are also some other data points that can assist you and i think that goes back to why you saw some increases in things like uh improvements in the in the area of graduation as well as chronic absenteeism because we work side by side with some school divisions to say how can you make a difference

[01:06:23] in this community with these students that you've identified and i think you will see that continuing in the future. So thank you. Okay. Well, I will start off by thanking Mrs. Coy, Dr. Sale, Dr. Pivarena, Dr. Ortiz, and Dr. Reby on that presentation. Certainly was a wealth of information. We basically went through three primary topics and slide decks. To try to organize

[01:07:00] some of the questions around the content and the speakers, I was going to recommend to maybe go back to the first presentation which was if you recall the overview of the revisions of the parts of the SOA one through seven and ask if anyone on the committee or even on the call has a question relative to the information that was shared in the first section of the presentation

[01:07:27] by Ms. Coy and Dr. Sale. Pausing for a minute making sure no one has looking back at their notes has any questions Dr. Pexton for that section yes Dr. Wilson so this is not a question but I did find it very helpful to have the overview of a reminder of each of the seven parts do you think

[01:08:02] that I think it was I don't remember if it was Dr. Sale or Dr. Pavarana but having no I'm sorry I'll hold that question for later but I did find that I did find the overview very helpful in that section. So, Dr. Dale, thanks for doing that. Okay. Thank you, Dr. Wilson. Any other thoughts or questions relative to that section before we move on to the next? All right. So, the next

[01:08:37] topic that was a presentation that was shared by Dr. Pavarenna was the state accreditation data review. And so, if you refer to that portion of the slide deck, I believe it was slide 15, starting at slide 15. I do have a couple questions in that section, but before I jump into my questions i'd like to open the floor up for any other additional comments or and or questions relative to the data review this is where i do have a couple of questions okay so dr pavarina

[01:09:13] thank you for bringing us back to our statistics class with the box plot box and whiskers and all that so really appreciate that um but you did note i think at the top of your presentation that this notion of achievement among student groups is one that would warrant its own presentation or its own time. I would be very interested in that because I do think that part of what the board intends for setting standards of accreditation generally, you know, going back to the the purpose

[01:09:49] of the soa to foster public confidence that graduates are ready and while the language in the in the purpose is general graduates we are responsible i think for ensuring that we are clear about the performance of all students as individually as we can i mean i know we can't get down to individual students but this idea of student groups and their performance is one that i would like to see broken out i i'm sorry i don't know what slide this is um i guess slides 18 19 21

[01:10:24] through 21 um and maybe even beyond that but as you've broken out performance in each of these areas generally i think it's you would be useful to understand what that looks like among student groups so that's item one the second um maybe real question in on slide um i don't know what slide this is the slide with distribution of English performance and then math performance

[01:10:58] do we know how many of how many schools are in the outlier in the outlier area or does that correlate then to what you have there on slide 26 so I can probably yeah yeah I can tell you that number i don't have it uh in front of me um but we can we can certainly get you that number it does not necessarily correlate to the number of slides i'm sorry the number of schools that are on slide 26. likely those outliers are probably level threes i would imagine that the box plots actually

[01:11:38] contain some level one and level two schools based on the distribution okay and then my last question if i could i'm on slide 26 i think it is with which is the percentage of schools improving their performance um how many um in that in that group of schools that have well the first or second column rather at level two or level three do we know how many of the schools appear in multiple

[01:12:17] indicators or more than one indicator yeah so we can certainly provide that information as a follow up as well um there's i we've talked before our thought about this before is kind of profiles of schools where we have schools that are high performing green across the board if you will we have a group of schools that just has one or two indicators where they're struggling and then a group of schools that that is struggling across the board but we can dig further into um the the sort of interweaving of these indicators for each school okay and then sorry last really the last

[01:12:52] thing and then how do that how does that list of schools or where there are schools that are having difficulty across the board how does that correlate then to the work of osq right so so so how are we deploying resources to the places where we know now based on this information we've got schools that continue to struggle. Thank you. I'll go ahead and chime in real quick before I open the floor back up because just to kind of piggyback on Jamel's train of thought on that same slide,

[01:13:28] also I would be interested in knowing which schools have not shown any progress at all based on this type of chart, maybe in an adjacent column that shows from that first cohort of the twos and threes, how many have not moved since. We can do that. Okay. All right. Any other questions from any others from the committee or in attendance before I add maybe another thought or question? Yes, I have a few questions and comments, Dr. Paxton. All right. Dr. Duran,

[01:14:06] and then we'll come to Pam. Okay. Thank you. First, sorry about my camera. It appears to not be working while I look like a ghost, but anyhow, I don't know what happened today. It's acting up. A few comments. First of all, it's very, I was very happy to see and I appreciated the detailed explanation on the combined rate and how we actually now can better understand and disaggregate those schools that are low performing and really pay attention to them in a way where you include growth. So that's just a positive comment that I wanted to make and appreciate how you outlined that for us. My concern and question really lies in the issue of the dropout rate. And on that

[01:14:45] slide. It doesn't have a number. I don't see it. So I've got the dropout slide. And I really, thank you. I'm really concerned and just wanting to hear your thoughts and reflection on the notion where the dropout rate is decreasing for our English learners. And I remain concerned with the notion that are we really capturing the dropout rate accurately for that group, particularly our students who are coming to us with limited or interrupted formal education and who are coming to us with little to no credits, and yet school districts and many schools are making great progress with them, helping getting them engaged, but yet they're counted as a dropout rate.

[01:15:24] So I'm really concerned still how we pay attention to those students that truly are dropping out, and we need to put our resources and attention to, but at the same time not be negatively impacting or looking at schools and students that really are not dropping out per se. It's the way that the calculation has been put in place with the fact that they're coming in so little credits or no credits and making progress and i really would love to hear your thoughts or comments on how we might best address that because i remain very very concerned about that one sure and i

[01:15:59] think we we definitely are um are very particular about our definition here and not uh really the definition of dropout as it's described here is a student whose status is either dropout or unconfirmed so a school doesn't know where they are can't locate them can't get a status on them and we don't really disaggregate the information or the dropout status any further than that and so certainly when we have students as you described SLIFE students for example who are coming in very perhaps very late or at an older age with just a few credits and trying to

[01:16:37] figure out what best works for them you know they are counted as dropouts if they do drop out of school I think philosophically you know there's a conversation there about is that the way that we want to classify these students and I think the department has been interested in and for some time and thinking through whether there is a way to you know capture the services that schools are providing to these students rather than to capture just specifically their outcome because if the schools are providing services to these students that result in a different outcome for example a

[01:17:13] grad graduating with a certificate or some other type of program completion then there may be some flexibility there in the way that we define dropout but that is that is not currently the way it's defined you are correct about that thank you for that explanation and i really want to encourage us and i'm glad to hear that you are looking at different measures or ways to capture that and through this process and i guess i'll share this with our chair uh dr pexton this is an area i hope that we will really look closely at and get some change to because i do think this um to our point that we talked about what have been the positive and unintended consequences i do believe

[01:17:52] that this has been a negative unintended consequence for schools and school divisions that are supporting life students and helping them make progress uh in other ways whether as you mentioned a certificate of completion or some other type of access to ongoing education and so i hope that we will as a committee pay attention to this and this is one that i just want to raise for my colleagues i'm very concerned about and and i want us to put our our heads together on how we can best support this population and the school systems and the schools and the principals and the teachers are doing phenomenal work with this group of students but yet at the same time not negating that there

[01:18:29] are students truly dropping out and we need to identify them it's not saying that we don't want to pay attention to drop out i for one want to and i'm glad that we're paying attention to drop out of students by uh disaggregating to see because often those students are forgotten even slice students are often forgotten in some cases so we need to pay attention to it but we also need to do it in a way that i think is better aligned to support the work that's the good work that's being done thank you madam chair that's all my comments and questions thank you for those comments Dr. Duran they were noted and I will now ask Ms. Davis thought for her thoughts or questions.

[01:19:08] Dr. Pexton, ladies thank you very much for that presentation. It was very thorough and it helped me to to dig a little bit deeper from my practice every day and just like all of you I have concerns and Dr. Duran you spoke so eloquently about all of those. I am concerned about the this group of children as well and i'm i would like to know more about the positives that are going on i would like to have some narratives if at all possible about the things that are going on the good things that are going on and how we can take a look at this population not just this life students but the

[01:19:45] economically disadvantaged children too as well so that we keep them in the forefront of our minds as we go through this process i think there are many wonderful things going on across the state and

i want to know what's happening with these children and the stories that are behind them so that we can do a better job with them individually in schools community services and as a board thank you thank you miss davis thought for for for making that point um i will go ahead and share now versus it was in my closing comments uh uh to address later uh again and and

[01:20:23] reviewing this information and really kind of assessing what we would be able to uh really capture and characterize as a opposite of what we still had more work to go do and piggybacking on Ms. Davis-Bott's comments. One suggestion that Emily and I discussed for, you know, we only have about two years worth of data and I think the board, the department's done a great job at at least sharing with us what we have available. But what we are going to propose at a future committee meeting is uh setting up uh hearing from other associations around the commonwealth

[01:21:03] to try to get some of that what will be anecdotal feedback uh but it will be feedback about some of what they're actually seeing relative to positive negative and unintended outcomes to the soa so we are going to get some of that empathy data uh from from from the actual environment at a future meeting and i think that hearing from the associations from around the commonwealth the various associations around the commonwealth will be a great audience for us to kind of synthesize some of that information so thanks for bringing that up and stayed the spot and just fyi i think that's something that we'll be able to consider and hear from down the road any other

[01:21:36] thoughts or comments uh from um the group and if i may jump in i was having some trouble with my audio and still am so i don't know if you can hear me okay but i'm gonna march forward here um I just want to make sure the board is really careful about the way that they approach this issue with English language learners and dropout rates and graduation rates. I do not want to do something that would otherwise mask the performance of students to make school performance look better.

[01:22:12] When you look at certificates of completion versus students that complete a high school graduation and their long-term outcomes in terms of uh quality of life there are significant differences there and as we looked at this issue last year whereas rates would improve with a certificate of incompletion it was not so many students that uh you know it it put us in a position where uh we felt like uh students would be ignored and forced into completion tracks that

[01:22:48] that otherwise could have graduated, and I just want to be really careful about not putting too much emphasis on the results getting better and putting more emphasis on actually making a difference in kids' lives.

[01:23:03] Dr. Peckson, can I respond? Yes, Dr. Durand. I agree, Dr. Lane, and my goal is not about the results getting better. My goal is that how school divisions and communities respond to this and to serving students they take actions and do things that in order to raise results because we set this marker for them so my concern is the actions and i've actually seen where this population of students is not being served the way they should be served because uh people have a misunderstanding of what

[01:23:40] we're trying to get them to do in this uh area and so i fully agree with you to me my goal is not about what the results need to be changed and look better i'm concerned about what type of services our students with our English language learners getting are they getting the right supports or are they getting used as a data point to try and make a score go up I'm not for that either I really though feel having seen this in practice in many school divisions and in some schools where they've done some great work that we

may be setting an accountability mark here that is causing changes in behavior and in practice or supporting students that we don't want to have happen it's really not

[01:24:18] helping them that's my concern yeah and i think that my recommendation would be that the board focus on creating standards of the type of supports that would be necessary but not removing any students from the calculation or otherwise counting types of completion that do not actually define graduation thank you so i i mean dr lane dr pecks and i and i welcome this dialogue because i think we need to have this and i also love what you said dr pecks and bringing other perspectives albeit anecdotal or not to tell us the story because I do think and it's something we're all

[01:24:58] learning with students with limited interrupted formal education or SLIFE students we're still trying to understand how do we best meet their needs and I think we have some good examples of that but I hope that as a commonwealth as a department of education we're setting some standards around that and I agree Dr. Lane how do we put that in place but how do we help educate all of our stakeholders of what it is that we're truly trying to accomplish what does this group truly need this is a unique set of students who we've not had a large experience with in virginia other parts of the country have so and i worry that sometimes accountability can be used in

[01:25:35] negative ways and students are not getting the supports they need and that's what i've seen happen in this area and so i'm look forward to future conversations i don't want on this topic but i do believe it's a one that needs some more clarity discussion and some potential revisions to to what we do yeah and and i i think you and i are on the same page i think that providing the right sports and tools and expectations for those students in terms of what they receive from an educational standpoint is right i just don't want to lower our expectations of what they can do purely because of their background i agree a thousand percent we do not need to lower that

[01:26:15] that's what's been happening for many of these students they're not getting because they're looked at as less than and they're not provided that high expectations so i fully support holding expectations high but how do we do it best and how do we make sure we're not creating another set of issues for for that group of students is all i want us to make sure we're clear on so thank you dr lane and dr peckson very good very good discussion and again i think that uh what i heard uh objectively listening to that discussion is i did hear kind of the same themes coming through as far as what our objective is or are are and that is basically making sure that what was

[01:26:55] intended uh for the soas to do that we actually see the reaction the behavior and the actions being taken to improve uh student performance because the indicators are telling us uh where we need to be making and causing that influence to occur so um and and i am confident we will get there as a committee so good discussion any other thoughts or discussions i would like to address the last portion of the presentation and then move on to our next uh presentation just to allow for time so any other questions relative to the uh uh data trends portion of the presentation

[01:27:32] my question was answered through some dialogue that you guys had so i'm good on mine i'm going to move forward to the last oh miss davis vault yes i would just like to say i appreciate very much the attitude of of serving and making sure that schools have the supports that they need and that comes across very clearly in your presentation and thank you very much for for putting that emphasis out there to help and assist and improve continuously so thank you thank you miss davis

[01:28:08] very much agreed the last section was school quality school quality actions and technical assistance uh presented by dr ortiz and dr rebia any any questions relative to that information that was shared no question okay no questions but just uh dr dron no questions just a comment thank you for the information and welcome to uh i'm sure if it's miss or dr ortiz but welcome

[01:28:38] i'm glad to have you here i do have a dr wilson question um knowing and and dr ortiz welcome um knowing the end um dr rivia thank you for your service um knowing that we have gone through our in the middle of perhaps or toward the tail end of this um transition right thinking differently about what osq does and how it supports uh schools um i would want to know you know now that we're

[01:29:13] we're we're headed in a direction solidly um how are we gonna know what are the indicators that we have out of osq that there that the support you all are providing is really making a difference right so we want to be more than you know than than than a partner on the side we really want to see and expect to see change and improvement this idea of continuous improvement in schools and so um at some point thinking about what those what is it that we can point to to say that the work of osq is actually delivering is helping us get further along and i know we can't necessarily

[01:29:51] um claim causation but what is the what is the corollary right of your work out of osq in supporting with the professional communities and all of those kinds of things what's going to be the what are we going to be looking for as an indicator to say uh we are we this office is making a difference in these particular ways and i so i'll be curious to hear that uh perhaps not today but i do think going forward um especially as the board in general is thinking about um our

[01:30:23] overall goal of ensuring that that schools and groups of students or individual students are moving forward so how are all of these inputs then translating into the outcome again not for today but something that i would be really interested in hearing at some point noted thank you dr wilson any other comments or questions okay i'm going to do a time check here we've got about a little

[01:31:00] less than 45 minutes left. We do have a 30-slide presentation that we are looking forward to hearing or learning about. So I will turn it over here and introduce our second presenters. I will go ahead and say in advance, I am a little bit of a time hawk. So at 11:45, I will be looking to kind of maybe cut the presentation at that point. I do want to leave the committee and others time to reflect and have questions if for some reason i'm hoping if we don't get all the way through all the information if we get a good enough proportion

[01:31:37] through that maybe we have to come back and wrap it up we can later but just fyi i do want to leave time to allow for q a at the end for our second presentation today we are pleased to be joined by alissa rafa and ben erwin with the education commission of the state their presentation will cover different types of school accountability systems some of the most common indicators used for school accountability, how different states combine data for decision marking, or maybe that is making, and information on how some other states use indicators, such as school climate and student discipline.

[01:32:13] As a policy analyst, Alyssa Rafa focuses on a variety of policy topics, including school climate and discipline, accountability, and school improvement and student health. health. Prior to joining ECS, Alyssa earned a master's degree in international students from the University of Denver and worked in public health policy. Ben Irwin serves as a policy researcher at ECS, where he tracks legislation, answers information requests, and contributes to policy team projects. Prior to joining ECS, Ben taught high school

[01:32:51] social studies in Kentucky and worked in education policy at the National Conference of State legislators. We are also joined by two other members from the ECS team, Joel Moore and I believe Lauren Cisneros, who will be observing. We are pleased to have you all with us today. So Alyssa

[01:33:12] and Ben, I will turn it over to you. And Ben, you're good to share our slides, right? All right.

[01:33:42] Awesome. So thanks everybody for having us here today and thanks for that really great introduction. We're going to really pull up the discussion to sort of the 30,000-foot level here. We're going to provide you with an overview of accountability systems across the country.

[01:33:59] So to kick us off, I'd just like to give you all a quick introduction to Education Commission of the States, or ECS. ECS is a nonpartisan, non-advocacy education research organization. We serve state-level education policy leaders across the United States.

[01:34:15] Our goal is really to be the essential, indispensable member of any team addressing education policy. you can see here we're unique because we serve a wide range of leaders on issues across the education spectrum from early learning through post-secondary and workforce and we do this in an effort to help those leaders make policy decisions from really solid foundation of research-based information because as you can see here we believe that information is power and informed policy makers create better education policy so how we do it we do this by researching and reporting on education issues we provide counsel to states as they approach those approach

[01:34:52] those issues and we provide opportunities for states to learn from one another through various convening opportunities so that is ecs and this is a quick road map of what we plan to cover today so first we'll do a little bit of level setting on state school accountability systems including some of the challenges and trade-offs associated with decision making in this space and then we'll get into the specifics with some national overviews of indicators school quality and student success included waiting and rating systems and reporting and presenting this information so let's go ahead and get started mindful of time um we're just

[01:35:29] going to go ahead and jump in right here on the big picture of accountability so broadly speaking when we talk about accountability we're talking about multiple systems serving multiple purposes related to measuring school performance for a variety of end users or audiences and i say this just to frame the issue i'm sure you all know these systems are very complex they're complex within each state and district and even more complex when we try to compare systems across states. So we'll talk a little bit about multiple systems here on this slide.

[01:35:59] Multiple systems can mean anything from separate systems to meet federal and state requirements to something like a separate school and a district system within that each have different performance measures and ratings. You can see this example on the slide from New Jersey. They currently have a school and a district system that they're working to align through ESSA implementation. And while there's a lot of value in aligning systems like this example shows there also may be reasons for states to maintain separate systems if they serve different purposes and multiple systems can also refer to separate or interwoven accreditation and accountability systems which you're all familiar

[01:36:35] with in these situations accreditation systems typically around the country measure inputs versus outcomes so things like teacher-student ratios or quality of school facilities and they usually give a less nuanced score than an accountability system, so accredited or not.

[01:36:52] Accountability systems generally seek to measure school quality through a variety of measures that we'll get into later in the presentation, and on this graphic you can see, I hope you can see it, that as of 2014 we are aware of about 26 states that use some form of accreditation and about six of those incorporate accreditation into their accountability system.

[01:37:13] So this multiple purposes and user slide really gets at the fundamental question of what's the purpose of an accountability system? And the answer is that even though there may be multiple purposes, depending on the user and the information collected, generally speaking, accountability systems are intended to measure schools and districts to report on that performance and to identify and improve those that are struggling. School performance is typically measured by a handful of indicators of student performance. States use that data to rate or grade school performance, and then they report on that performance. And this is where multiple

[01:37:49] users really come into play states have to take into account that a student or a parent may want to know different things about a school than a district or a state leader right to try to reach various users states will often report additional information about schools on their public facing report card things like teacher qualifications school climate data measures of student or parent engagement even if that information is not does not officially count for purposes of the school's overall accountability rating and then the last activity improving schools is what we think of as sort of step two in accountability so first you rate a school then you decide what to do about

[01:38:27] schools receiving poor ratings via your state system for school improvement and i won't spend too much time on this slide but i really like to show it because i think it's a nice visual depiction of what trade-offs exist as states continue to iterate on the design of their accountability systems one of the more common trade-offs we hear about is between giving a school a single grade or score so an a through f or a one through five stars with summative rating which some argue really oversimplifies the important nuances in school performance versus only providing ratings or grades on individual measures and some argue that's

[01:39:03] overly confusing to different users parents and the public and this isn't necessarily an either or proposition but you'll see some specific areas where these trade-offs show up throughout our presentation so I wanted to include this graphic here also mostly for your future reference.

[01:39:20] Now I'm going to go ahead and hand it over to Ben and he's going to go over national overviews, more specifics on accountability systems. Thanks Alyssa and good morning everyone. Although some states utilize these separate systems for state and federal accountability purposes, we're really going to be focused specifically on state accountability systems within their ESSA plan. So really focusing on that federal accountability perspective.

[01:39:51] So this national overview that we're going to provide is informed by our 50-state comparison that was completed in May of 2018. It's important to note that after final approval, we're aware of at least 30 states that have received approval for amendments to their ESSA plans. These really vary in impact and substance, but they could affect the accountability system. And we just wanted to make it clear that these changes weren't necessarily included in the 50 state comparison.

[01:40:22] So ESSA requires states to include at least five indicators measuring school performance, four academic indicators, and a fifth measure of school quality and student success. So I'm sure a lot of you all are aware of these four academic indicators including achievement, another academic indicator, high

school graduation rates, and English language. We're going to focus a little more specifically on school quality and student success indicators are required under ESSA because they really give states the opportunity to develop these more holistic measures

[01:40:56] and rate schools or judge schools outside of purely academic academic measures. States have a lot of flexibility. We've we've tracked and identified some common choices for school quality and student success indicators and these include college and career readiness chronic absenteeism, school climate, and other SQSS indicators that we're going to look at today include school discipline, access and achievement gap closure.

[01:41:28] So to start with college and career readiness, at least 39 states use a variety of college and career readiness measures. These measures really look different across the states, but we've identified some common ones, including the completion of advanced coursework, college entrance exam, CT trade certificates, work keys or other academic readiness assessments, performance on the ASVAB, the military readiness assessment, on track to graduation metrics, and even civic education requirements in some instances.

[01:42:01] To look more closely at some state examples, Tennessee's college and career readiness indicator incorporates student performance on the ACT and SAT, completion of early post-secondary opportunities, So what that looks like is dual enrollment, advanced placement, international baccalaureate.

[01:42:19] They also include industry certifications in approved CTE programs, performance on the ASVAB, and yeah, that's really the different paths to college and career readiness that they offer.

[01:42:35] New York similarly offers a variety of indicators to show college and career readiness or a variety of measures, including earning an advanced diploma, CTE endorsement, sealed by literacy, completing advanced coursework, so AP, IB, dual enrollment, a passing score on their state alternative assessment, and among other options for demonstrating college and career readiness. And finally, we're going to look a little more closely at North Dakota, and North Dakota ties their accountability to their Choice Ready

[01:43:09] graduate framework a choice ready graduate is a student who has met requirements in either the post-secondary ready workforce ready or military ready category and a lot of these requirements are really mirror what you see in other states similar to tennessee and new york in terms of the different options for college and career readiness but they also include these essential skills that every graduate needs to meet before being considered choice ready and those skills or measures include completing 25 hours of community service, completing two or more years of

[01:43:45] co-curricular or extracurricular activities, completing a capstone project or in an online learning course, and finally demonstrating competency in these 21st century skills. And these are outlined in their state standards, but they're viewed more, these competencies are viewed more like not necessarily within the academic realm. They might include critical thinking and things like that that are just these broader skills that you build through your time in school.

[01:44:15] So moving on to chronic absenteeism, there are 36 states that utilize chronic absenteeism as a school quality and student success indicator. And similar to Virginia, most states are using this 10

threshold as the measure for chronic absenteeism. So if a student is missing more than 10 percent of their school days, they're considered chronically absent.

[01:44:39] to look more specifically at a state example we decided to pull rhode island because they also use teacher absenteeism which has become a larger part of this absenteeism conversation in recent years because we're we know that it has a pretty significant impact on student achievement as well rhode island uses this 10 threshold for both teacher and student absenteeism and they provide a research rationale in their ESSA plan for its conclusion.

[01:45:09] First, they realize that it is a predictive metric of dropout and low academic achievement. They also know that teacher absenteeism can lead to a lower quality of instruction just because at times there can be a lack of consistency and they provide state data to in their ESSA plan to show that this is a way to meaningfully differentiate between schools so they really do have a broad range of absenteeism rates across the state and finally they outline these broader equity concerns because they've identified that lower income students are much more likely to be

[01:45:46] chronically absent. And shifting gears to school climate we're aware of at least nine states that measure school climate and their state has a plan for their federal accountability system and really the way that they're measuring this is predominantly using these school climate surveys but states are also including different outcome measures such as chronic absenteeism or suspension rates within this school climate metric in idaho their satisfaction and engagement surveys are we included this example because it's administered to students and staff as well as

[01:46:25] parents and this is all all of this data is utilized in the indicator so they're incorporating this community broader community and perspective as well by including parents Maryland's school survey is administered to all students grades five through 11 and they're focusing on these really four key areas of relationships within the school building: engagement, school environment, and school safety as well. We're going to take a little bit of a closer look at Iowa's conditions for learning survey. They use three domains: safety, engagement,

[01:47:01] and environment, and they're using survey data as well as what they're calling school-level incident data to come up with a really holistic metric for each one of these things. And this leads to their IS index score, which is essentially their school climate index score.

[01:47:21] I'll stay on the slide just for a few more seconds because I think this graphic really illustrates how they're using this data, how they're constructing the survey around these different elements. All right, and now finally to finish off with a look at these other school quality and student success indicators we identified the most common ones as school climate kind of absenteeism and college and career readiness but states have really chosen a variety of metrics that

[01:47:57] we think align with the state priorities and with colorado they're using dropout and re-enrollment rates in kentucky they're using a pretty large opportunity and access indicator that looks different across different grade spans but they incorporate multiple measures including access to the arts access to cte health science social studies cultural studies world languages and other rigorous coursework and they're also incorporating measures of climate chronic absenteeism behavior events and the use of restraint and seclusion so we're going to talk

[01:48:33] about the trade-offs for an indicator like this a little more when we're discussing weighting but they've chosen to incorporate a lot of different data points to come to this one indicator score for their school quality and student success indicator um next vermont uses science achievement which is isn't uncommon but they also included a physical fitness measure which was um definitely um not as common from state to state and then finally west virginia explicitly uses school discipline as i mentioned some schools are incorporating school discipline

[01:49:09] rates into their school climate metric but west virginia is looking at the number of students with zero out of school suspensions both california and rhode island are using a similar metric as well and to finish up with the school quality and student success indicators we wanted to take a closer look at georgia although we know that subgroup performance has to be disaggregated disaggregated for each indicator across or across indicators under ESSA and it's tied to the identification of schools for improvement. Some states have given achievement gaps and achievement

[01:49:46] gap closure additional weight in their accountability system. Some are using it as their other academic indicator while Georgia has taken a different approach and they've incorporated a couple different equity measures into their plan as a school quality and student success indicator so first what they call their well-rounded indicator is also known as their beyond the core indicator they're looking at course access and successful completion of courses in the fine arts world languages physical education and health and as well as career exploration so they're trying to measure schools based on what kind of access they provide to these

[01:50:26] course offerings kind of outside of some core core content and they also use achievement gap closure in two unique ways so they have an achievement gap indicator that's really looking at math and ela achievement gaps and that's given about i think seven and a half percent weight in their system but they've also incorporated an indicator looking at achievement gaps in science and social studies so they're really honing in on what are what do achievement gaps look like in schools across these four core subjects. And then finally, just before I pass it

[01:51:01] back to Alyssa, I wanted to offer just a really brief overview of weighting. Although we know that academic indicators, ESSA requires that they be given much greater weight, ESSA doesn't really outline what this looks like. So states are given quite a bit of flexibility to determine weighting and this really kind of this really outlines what the state's priorities are what they're giving more weight in the accountability system so for example you might see in elementary and middle schools growth are given additional weight while achievement might be given additional

[01:51:35] weight at the high school level we've also seen states look give more weight to their adjusted cohort graduation rates their five and six year rates in comparison to their four-year while other states might only use their four-year for federal accountability purposes. And then just to close with looking at the school quality and student success weighting, as I mentioned, Kentucky uses like five to six different data points to give one school quality and student success indicator score. And some might argue that this dilutes the weight of each indicator

[01:52:13] and doesn't give it doesn't give as much weight to their priorities while others would argue that you're getting a more holistic picture for this indicator um and then other states have focused really on using chronic absenteeism using a school climate survey using a college and career readiness measure for that school quality and student success indicator because that's what they're prioritizing and they want

that to be given a little bit more um so as i mentioned this waiting really helps to identify state priorities for us depending on how much weight they're giving to each indicator and Alyssa is really going to take a closer look at the ways in

[01:52:51] which these weights impact school rating systems which then impact how schools are presented to the public and also identified for improved. So I will pass it along to Alyssa. Thanks Ben. So now I'm going to dig into some common rating systems across the country. The information presented here is based on state ESSA plans and the key here that you can see is ordered by how common each measure is across the country and in the interest of time I won't get into too much detail on what each rating system looks like but I'll just note that those first five rating systems

[01:53:29] are summative ratings so they provide a clear overall rating for us at the school level or district level and that last piece the no summative piece indicates that those states don't provide a summative or overall rating for schools or districts. Alright so a little more detail on those states that provide no summative rating. This is a real point of interest for a lot of states right now. So California is probably the most often cited and followed state that utilizes this approach. They use a color-coded rating system for each indicator but not for the school or district level and they present this information through an online dashboard.

[01:54:08] they use a color-coded matrix system on the back end also that measures current performance on indicators and improvement over time to arrive at an overall performance rating but behind the scenes i'll show a visual of the dashboard model on the next slide here but before i do oregon rates each indicator at a one through five level on their report card and they provide no summative rating for the entire school the state similar to california also uses sort of a matrix system to identify schools for improvement behind the scenes. Unlike Oregon and California, Idaho and North Dakota do not provide ratings on their front-facing report card for individual indicators.

[01:54:47] Their dashboards are very data-focused, providing a lot of information on academic and non-academic indicators. And while neither of those states arrive at a public-facing summative rating, both states indicate a process for using that data to identify schools for improvement.

[01:55:04] we'll go to the next slide Ben for the California dashboard so these are a few snapshots of what that dashboard looks like in California currently it changes regularly you can see the color-coded system here per indicator as well as some information on the student population and interestingly there's also some information included on certain indicators around how specific student groups are performing on that indicator in that equity report section that you might not be able to see very clearly but it's at the bottom and this model of report card really gets us back to that trade-offs conversation the difficulty may be with interpretation versus

[01:55:43] oversimplifying and just saying this school or district gets a b or a c so these are a few examples of those first five categories of summative states that provide summative ratings the vast majority of states do this Massachusetts uses a descriptive rating system that's scaled from a school of recognition through a few levels to a school that gets broader comprehensive support they use information related to progress toward improvement targets and accountability percentiles to arrive at that summative rating Colorado uses a tiers of support rating system

[01:56:19] that's tied directly to their state identification model so they use the same terminology on the report card that they use to determine improvement categories front-facing and Georgia's college and and

Career Readiness Performance Index is scaled from one through 100, and it includes several indicators of student achievement, ultimately providing schools with a final score on that one to 100 scale.

[01:56:41] And then Ohio that we'll get into here in the next slide as well, uses an A through F rating system for their overall rating, as well as A through F for each individual indicator that they present. This next slide will show you what that actually looks like.

[01:56:57] You can see here that individual ratings for each indicator that they call component grades, And then at the top, the overall school grade given. And this slide also shows a representation of financial data that's now required through the financial transparency requirement in ESSA, as you all know, I'm sure.

[01:57:15] Ohio provides information on per-pupil spending as well as the percentage of funds spent on classroom instruction in those three pie charts on the left. And we made it through all of those slides in the time given.

[01:57:30] So this is a quick list of resources related to accountability for your reference. And then, yeah, just Q&A now, I think we're ready for that. Thanks everybody for your time. That's really a lot of information in a short amount of time. And we're happy to take any questions.

[01:57:46] Please know that if we can't answer them, we can bring them back to our research team and provide you with pretty thorough memos of any information or anything we didn't cover that you're interested in learning about.

[01:58:02] Oh, Dr. Pexson, I think you're muted. - I think you are correct. Thank you for that information. I really appreciate the information you shared. very insightful. And so now I would like to open the floor up to the committee members

[01:58:20] and other attendees for any initial thoughts and questions. Okay. Dr. Paxton, sorry. Yes, Dr. Duran. I just want to thank you for your presentation. Very, very insightful. I'm just wondering if you have any comments or suggestions for us based on the work we're

[01:58:55] about to embark upon and what you see looking nationally at other states. Anything that you see here in Virginia that's either something that really stands out positively or something that you would consider us to look a little deeper into. Just wondering your thoughts on that.

[01:59:10] Thank you. Yeah, it's quite interesting for us as we present across the country on things like this that can be so very detailed as you see in the first half of this meeting, right, can be so, so detailed and interestingly also we tend to see the states that are really engaging in the good work are the ones that invite us to come speak to them.

[01:59:35] So it's great for us to be able to see all of the really good work that you're already doing. The only piece of advice I would have is to really do what you're already doing, which is paying attention to those trade-offs, balancing those trade-offs, and paying attention to any unintended consequences that might come from choices that are made, and then shifting course when and where you need to.

[01:59:59] So I think you all are doing really great work, and yeah, I appreciate you inviting us. Thank you very much. Thank you, Dr. Pekson. - Yeah, I'd second that. I think having conversations about unintended consequences is a super important aspect of accountability, and the fact that you are conducting those already is wonderful.

[02:00:21] - Okay, thank you. I will ask one question. I know we went through the information very quickly, and I appreciate that so that we could have this time, but just to maybe go back a little bit about, 'cause the conversation or the question around school discipline as an indicator came up uh in some of our earlier discussions as a committee and i you mentioned briefly that west virginia uses it as one of its other uh um um indicators and so could you could you talk a little bit more about what that actually looks like uh just for the group to understand so in

[02:01:00] west virginia specifically they're using um the number of students within a school building who have zero out of school suspensions to determine their rate breached school so they're looking at that number in comparison to the entire student population and then that is what's going into their school quality and student success indicator okay i do think it's more common dr pexton for states to include school discipline as one aspect or school discipline data as one part of their overall school climate indicator i think that's the more common approach to incorporate chronic

[02:01:37] absenteeism rates as well as rates of suspension and expulsion in an overall indicator of school climate as opposed to school discipline standing alone i think that's the more common approach yeah so iowa's conditions for learning survey we stopped at that chart for just a little bit they'll use the school level incident data and um one of that school level incident data will include in and out of school suspensions and um different referrals to law enforcement different things like that in conjunction with the survey of students and staff to come to that like more

[02:02:10] complete picture as well okay thank you for that that explanation and so i'm not quite sure what context to put my next add-on question and i don't know if it would be relative to what your organization would pay attention to or if it's data that you see if you if you see look to see if other states are paying attention to, but again, relative to student discipline, is there data or criteria that represents whether or not there's any disproportional impact to minorities relative to school discipline? Are we seeing any of that data available that's

[02:02:48] telling us that if any of that is happening relative to that indicator? Yeah, so I'm not, I can speak to national level data in that space, and yes, we know that that's absolutely happening i think black students are suspended at 3.7 times the rate of their uh white peers in schools i think you know that's a national level number and within each state they are required to report on that now they aren't required to include that data in their accountability system um when it comes to what states are seeing within their school climate

[02:03:28] indicator i'm not sure what that looks like quite yet and i think that would be a pretty detailed question that we could look into for you based on those states that incorporate school discipline into their school climate indicator um so if that's something you'd be interested in we can certainly follow up with more information on that yes i would thank you very much so uh and then the last question i had was relative to chronic absenteeism um you know i know uh the the focus this committee is looking at the original standards and their you know intended outcomes um and and

[02:04:05] and and what do they look like today and it's a little challenging to to look at that data absent of you know covid and and the impact it's having and will have but relative to the covet conversation and chronic absenteeism the way a lot of states are are capturing or that that indicator you know what what are some of the discussions right now happening today that what does that look like today and i'm really not trying to be facetious but is it that the kid has to have his or her camera on um when when school starts

that the teacher actually knows they're there you know what does that conversation look like today around chronic absenteeism in the in the children showing

[02:04:42] up for virtual learning so to speak it's a really good question uh we don't know that's the answer yet um i think that's something that we would be asking you all is saying what what are you doing as a state to sort of shift if you're using that measure in your accountability system what are you doing to shift how that is being calculated to account for the virtual or hybrid learning models that you're engaging in um right i wish we had an answer for you and hopefully we will soon but that's sort of a suggestion we're making to states is make sure and you know in this world where

[02:05:20] you're not going to waive accountability requirements and assessment requirements potentially for the next school year because you know that's sort of what happened in the spring I'm looking forward make sure that you're paying attention to what those how those indicators are being measured it's a really good certainly we have actually provided school districts with guidance on this topic so the next time you get together we can share with you what this looks like but essentially just so you know we have allowed districts to go from a time-based attendance to a task-based attendance as an option

[02:05:55] and so chronic absenteeism may be defined by a student's inability to show any evidence of their engagement in school rather than whether they showed up every day right that's exactly what i was going to bring that connection so it's not necessarily about being present it is about being engaged certainly being present uh fosters engagement but it's really about what is the kid doing or the student doing while in the presence of the educator or and or his or her peers

[02:06:29] so the question of engagement for me is one that's interesting and sorry excuse me thank you i'm glad you brought that up because we have been getting a lot of questions about what does it look like to measure um virtual learning and engagement and as dr lane said we've seen a lot of states issuing guidance and leaving some flexibility for districts but project-based learning different assignment completion and that tax task based approach has been very common we have seen legislation relaxing that the hour or day or instructional day measurement requirements

[02:07:07] just to provide that flexibility to districts i think that's the trend we've seen thus far but in terms of chronic absenteeism data i think states are figuring out how to measure attendance first and then kind of seeing where that takes them and seeing what the data looks like from there Great. All very helpful. Thank you. Any other questions or thoughts before we wrap up this committee session?

[02:07:39] All right. Emily, if it's okay, I was planning on sharing my screen, and I believe I am technically capable of doing so. We shall see here. So, I have tried to organize some of our original tasking that we identified as a committee opposite of what we addressed today, opposite of what we still need to address, and just some notes.

[02:08:07] And so, if I could get some virtual nods that people can see my screen. So, this is kind of how I organize my thoughts around this. Some of the ideas, suggestions, questions over the last couple of meetings, there was a suggestion to consider minimum expectations for instructional programs.

[02:08:28] I feel like we did at least get to understand or see some information today from the BDOE presentation about instructional programs. There was a request for resources DOE has put into support for schools around SOA again. I think that that was part of our presentation today.

[02:08:47] We obviously clearly talked a lot about chronic absenteeism from the VDOE standpoint, as well as information from ECS at the national level. There was a suggestion to examine other models and structures of accreditation around the country, and we certainly got an opportunity to understand that today.

[02:09:07] I categorized the feedback that I kind of bubbled up under just indicators. Thank you, and we will do categorize this information and indicators to understand implications to eat to eat to our ELL was one was one request, obviously, we had some good discussion about that today.

[02:09:31] We saw that at the video level national level relative to graduation rates completion absenteeism dropout rates, but we know there's more discussion and opportunities to have there. There was a request to look at college and career readiness, the VDOA, excuse me, I put VA, still in the process of collecting that data.

[02:09:49] But because we know that it will not come online until 21 to 21, school year 21, 22, we did see a little bit of that information today at the national level. And then there was a request to look at how growth measures were determined and we saw a little bit of that in the national level and the ECS presentation, but there's probably a little bit more meat that we could put on that bone or look at that down the road, excuse me.

[02:10:14] So, some additional things, key tasks that we as a committee identified that we were interested in that I think we still have a little bit ways to go on, you know, two indicators. It was mentioned in a previous meeting that two indicators did not make the 2017 SOAs. It was student discipline, and there was a point of whether or not it was disproportional to black students.

[02:10:33] And that was, you know, part of my question at the national level that asked Mr. Irwin and Ms. Rafa. uh so we we discussed that uh with emily that uh that that kind of data is not necessarily readily available if i'm not mistaken emily please correct me with the videoe uh but it's something that we could maybe look into assessing how we could get that information or look at some variation of it um and then there was a the other indicator of school climate uh there was we were told that do he has that information and obviously say we learned a little bit more about it at both

[02:11:09] the state and national level. There is also some information requested about the current accreditation system's effect on the vulnerable populations, pre-K through three, high poverty, obviously ELL, transitional families. We heard a little bit of those, the data points today as relative to graduation completion absentees and dropout rate. Again, I think there's some more discussion there. It was noted about Dr. Duran's comment about the potential negative unintended consequence of the dropout rate for ELL learners. And I think there's some more that the team would like to unpack and we might be able to um um take away from uh hearing from associations some of

[02:11:48] that anecdotal feedback i think we might be able to get some of those questions answered or at least get a feel for the impact of some of our vulnerable populations at a later time and of course as i opened up uh there was a a collective desire just to really overall understand really the positive negative and unintended consequences of the system and again i think that at future committee meetings um what uh i'd like to tee up and what i plan on discussing offline with dr lane and emily for the next meeting is what we've talked about you know lining up uh some presentations from other

[02:12:22] associations about what they're seeing anecdotally from their perspectives um i also want to point out a document that was provided to the committee uh in preparation for this meeting it was um it examined how the state accreditation system is aligned with the federal accreditation requirements there was a comparison chart provided i know that uh i'm speaking with emily i know that for me having a little bit of dialogue about that comparison to kind of unpack that data would be helpful for me so i asked that maybe we could take 15 20 minutes at another meeting to just flash that up and really just have a dialogue about it make sure there's no questions so i

[02:12:57] think that's something that we'll address at a future meeting as well and then emily also shared that the ddoe has an internal staff soa work group and may have been also reviewing the 2017 soa uh revisions just like we are and so they will have some items to bring to the board for consideration uh for the to this committee to uh for consideration during our review so that's just an fyi for this committee as well but that perspective will be coming also so um any any questions uh i just tried to really synthesize capture you know using my whole mission analysis

[02:13:34] document what the team was interested in learning more about opposite of where we are today but i will pause there to see if there's any comments questions or anything else the committee would like to make sure we get added to future committee meeting presentations other than what was specifically asked for throughout the presentations today uh dr wilson did you have a comment yes yes just a suggestion i agree that having staff walk us through the chart in the comparison chart will be very helpful. We've also though in coming to our Virginia's final or current

[02:14:14] approach to ESSA, we went through several iterations and so I think understanding some of the historical path, not the complete because it's long, but how we got to where we are will be helpful to us to remember the choices we made and to some degree why we either had to make the choice that we did or we chose that we did and is that i'm just for clarification when you say understanding how we got to where we are can you put that in smaller context you mean relative

[02:14:48] to the final determination of the 2017 soas that is correct and yeah and and how um yeah why we end up in some instances why we end up with the with uh the indicator virginia's essa indicator that we do right so the board may have started in one place or the staff may have started in one place but we end up somewhere else and so where there are those um were changes as staff is bringing us the kind of the walking us through the comparison it may help to answer some questions that folks

[02:15:24] may have that's my only um my only observations okay all right thank you any other comments before we wrap up with next meeting information oh it looks very good great thank you dr dron there There were a couple other topics that are not listed above.

[02:15:46] You know, there's some discussion around the COVID Accreditation Task Force, kind of getting an update on from that group, which I've deferred to Emily and Dr. Lane as far as the best timing for that, for us to get that information. The question about whether they're moving from a competency-based rather than an age-based model.

[02:16:03] I think that's a conversation down the road. We wanted to get some other, you know, educational perspectives, informational perspectives before we went down there. And then there was a question asked the implications of the SOQs and the equity work to date and we're going to have some more discussion on that later on once Emily and I kind of come to grips with how the best way to address that information so right now our next meeting is scheduled as part of our board meeting it'll be on

September 16th and Wednesday afternoon committee meetings that's going to be our planned drumbeat initially for the next couple of months I do want to be sensitive to September and even now i know many people are back in school and getting ready for school but as of right now that's the

[02:16:42] plan for the drumbeat of this committee every wednesday uh uh in conjunction with board meetings and possibly in the off months like this month and it'll usually be around 2 p.m um so with that i'd like to conclude uh the meeting this this meeting of the committee of the standard review of the standards of accreditation i'd like to thank all of our presenters uh for preparing the information and for sharing it with us and answering our questions like the things that the virginia department of education for their support of this committee and preparing for this meeting and for future presentation and i'd like to thank my committee members for joining me today any

[02:17:19] other thoughts or questions before we wrap up thanks for a great uh great meeting well organized and executed yes thank you thank you very much thank you very much appreciate good job i'm sorry was that thank you thank you appreciate that and thank you for the extra three minutes and everybody stay safe and enjoy the rest of your afternoon. Bye, everybody. Bye.

